

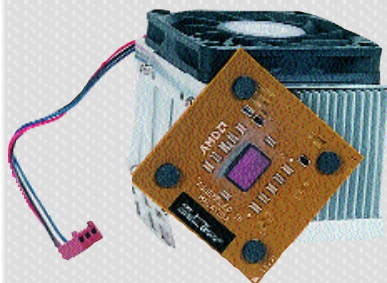
Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

AMD Athlon XP 2600+

Pedigree processor

Built using a tweaked Thoroughbred core, this 2.13 GHz processor promises performance equivalent to a 2.6 GHz Pentium 4!



The processor was put to test using MadOnion's Bapco Sysmark 2002 and Business Winstone 2001 to log its data crunching and office application potential. It scored a low index of 169 in the MadOnion's Bapco Sysmark 2002 test that evaluates its performance in day-to-day tasks. A fair comparison would be with the P4 2.53 GHz which scores in excess of 180. Interestingly, the XP 2600+ zoomed past the P4 2.53 GHz in the Business Winstone 2001 test, where it logged an impressive 76.8, a hairbreadth short of the 76.9 logged by the P4 2.8 GHz.

These seemingly contradictory scores can be explained by the fact that Business Winstone 2001 uses older versions of Office applications, while the newer versions used by the Sysmark 2002 suite are slightly optimised for

the P4. In practical terms, most Office applications wouldn't make even a 1 GHz CPU sweat.

Heavy-duty, CPU-intensive video editing and 3D rendering is what poses some challenge to these multi-GHz CPUs. We used the SPECviewPerf 7.0 test suite for the rendering tests and the XP 2600+ returned scores to be proud of, beating almost the entire range of P4 processors.

However, on the gaming front, XP 2600+ logged lower frame rates than the P4 processors—in *Quake III* the P4 2.8 GHz in normal mode scored an amazing 434.2 fps, while the XP 2600+ managed only about 353.2 fps. The difference narrowed down when the game was played at the maximum resolution (1024x768x32)—the XP 2600+ scored 294.3 fps against the 300 fps logged by the P4 2.8 GHz.

3DMark2001SE is probably the only benchmark where the XP 2600+ comes close to the P4 in gaming performance—it scored a pretty neat 12,095 compared to the 12,595 logged by the P4 2.8 GHz.

Overall, the XP 2600+ is fast and performs almost on par with its specified PR rating. More importantly, it

is comparatively inexpensive. But sadly, it still runs hot (71 degree centigrade CPU core temperature) and the high rpm fans used to cool it are a very noisy solution.

Price: Rs 17,820
Contact: AMD Far East Ltd
Phone: 011-6281364
E-mail: rahul.singh@amd.com

SPECIFICATIONS

Thoroughbred core, 2133 MHz core frequency, 266 MHz (133 MHz DDR) default FSB, 0.13 micron processing technology, 128 KB L1 and 256 KB L2 cache, Socket A interface

AMD Athlon XP 2600+	B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

MSI KT4 Ultra

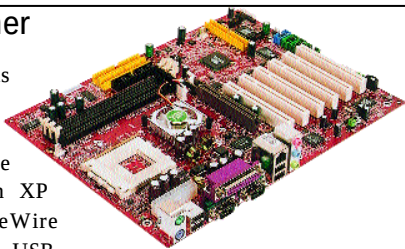
The ultra performer

This motherboard is built around the VIA KT400 chipset and is a top contender for the newly launched Athlon XP processor. It supports FireWire (IEEE 1394), Bluetooth, USB 2.0, AGP 8x, Gigabit Ethernet and Serial ATA (SATA) RAID.

We tested the board with the Athlon XP 2600+ and 256 MB DDR 333 specified RAM. It performed well in all our tests, showing no signs of sluggishness or instability.

The Athlon XP, when paired with this motherboard, zooms past the P4 2.8 GHz in the intensive SPECviewPerf 7.0 tests. The Business Winstone 2001 score of 76.8 is top notch and an index of 169 in MadOnion's Bapco Sysmark 2002 is as fast as the processor can crunch.

The gaming scores were impressive too. In *Quake III*



at maximum resolution (1024x768x32), it scores 294.3 fps. To check the motherboard's thermal protection, we turned off the CPU fan and the board almost instantaneously brought the system to a halt.

This motherboard offers unmatched quality and performance and is recommended to all AMD fans and performance enthusiasts!

SPECIFICATIONS

VIA KT400 chipset, supports FireWire, Bluetooth, USB 2.0, AGP 8x, Gigabit Ethernet and Serial ATA (SATA) RAID

Price: Rs 7,850
Contact: Priya Ltd
Phone: 022-2663611
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MSI KT4 Ultra	A-
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶